Called to
Edit

The workbook

Your first 60 days to your first client

One clear task a day. Simple steps, no fluff.



Samuel Adebayo
VIDEO EDITOR AND COACH

START HERE

How this works

1. **One day at a time.** Each day has one or two tasks and a clear finish line: **Done when**.
2. **Missed a day?** Pick up where you stopped. It's 60 steps, not 60 dates.
3. **Every day, post about your journey.** Two to three posts. Ideas on the next page.
4. **Stuck?** Each day names the book chapter it comes from.

TYPING IN THIS WORKBOOK

Tap a box to type or tick. Open the file in **Adobe Acrobat Reader** (free on Android and iPhone), Xodo or Google Drive. If you can't tap a box, open it in Acrobat Reader.

IN THE COMMUNITY

Share each day's work in the Called to Edit Community. I'll give you feedback and guide you as you go.

EVERY DAY

What to post

Post your journey, not just finished work. Mix it like this:

40% AUTHENTIC

Your day, your story, your wins and failures. “Day 12 of 60: learning captions.” A photo of your timeline. A client who said no.

40% AUTHORITY

Teach what you’re learning. “3 mistakes in business videos.” A before and after. Your recreation next to the original.

20% SALES

Say what you do. “I edit ___ for ___. I’m taking on new clients.”

THE PLAN

Your 60 days

Tap a day to jump to it.

PHASE 1 Set your direction

DAYS 1–7

1 Make time for this
2 Find out who pays
3 Choose your niche
4 Write your offer
5 Check your tools
6 Fill your feed with editing
7 Set up your profile

PHASE 2 Learn on real videos

DAYS 8–21

8 Make your learning list
9 Learn your software (part 1)
10 Learn your software (part 2)
11 Cut your first practice video
12 Pacing and audio
13 Captions
14 Finish video 1
15 Pick an edit to copy
16 Recreate it
17 Start video 2
18 Finish video 2
19 Start video 3
20 Finish video 3
21 Get feedback

PHASE 3 Real people, real work

DAYS 22–35

22 Write your warm list

23 Offer free work, with a limit

24 Ask around

25 Brief your first project

26 Edit the project

27 Deliver on time

28 Save the proof

29 Keep going

30 Meet 5 editors

31 Build your portfolio site

32 Polish your profile

33 Ask for a testimonial

34 Ask for a token

35 Write your first case study

PHASE 4 Go get your first client

DAYS 36–60

36	Start your client list
37	Grow it to 20
38	Warm them up
39	Set your prices
40	Get paid safely
41	Send your first DMs
42	Send your first emails
43	Edit their video first
44	Send it everywhere
45	Pitch on video
46	Follow up
47	Get ready for “How much?”
48	Practise a call
49	Your daily rhythm
50–55	Keep the rhythm
56	Check your numbers
57–59	Do more of what works
60	Look back, plan the next 60

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PHASE 1 · DAYS 1–7

Set your direction

Choose who you edit for, say it in one sentence, and get visible.

“If you are targeting everyone, you have no one.”

DAY 1

20 MIN

Make time for this

BOOK: CHAPTERS 1–3

Two focused hours every day beat eight hours once a week.

Today

1. Read Chapters 1 to 3 of the book.
2. Choose the time you'll give this every day, and put it in your calendar.

My daily time for the next 60 days

☐ **Done when:** It's blocked in your calendar.

DAY 2

45 MIN

Find out who pays

BOOK: CHAPTER 4

Your niche is the type of client and video you focus on. In any niche, business people pay more, because they already understand marketing.

Today

1. Write down 3 kinds of videos you enjoy watching.
2. For each one, look at 3 creators who make them. Do they sell something: a product, a course, a service? If they sell, they can pay you.

My 3 options, and what those creators sell

- [ ] **Done when:** You have 3 options written down.

DAY 3

30 MIN

Choose your niche

BOOK: CHAPTER 4

If you are targeting everyone, you have no one. Pick the option where creators make money and your tools can handle the videos.

Today

1. Pick one option from yesterday.
2. Pick long videos or short videos. Long pays more per video; short sells in bigger numbers.

I edit ___ videos for ___ on ___ (platform)

- [ ] **Done when:** You can finish that sentence.

DAY 4

30 MIN

Write your offer

BOOK: CHAPTER 4

Don't say “I'm a video editor”. Say who you help and what they get.

MY EXAMPLE

“I help business creators get 10,000 views in 3 months through video editing.”

Today

1. Fill in: I help **who** get **what result** in **how long** through **how**.
2. Make it more specific once. Read it out loud.

My offer sentence

☐ **Done when:** You can say it in one breath.

DAY 5

20 MIN

Check your tools

BOOK: CHAPTER 5

Your device decides which videos you can sell right now. Start with what you have.

Today

1. Look at the videos in your niche. Can your phone or laptop edit them?
2. If not, switch to videos it can handle, for example short videos on a phone.

- [ ] My device can edit the videos I chose
- [ ] My software is legal, not cracked

- [ ] **Done when:** Both boxes are ticked.

DAY 6

40 MIN

Fill your feed with editing

BOOK: CHAPTER 8

Surround yourself with your niche. Pick one platform; Twitter (X) and LinkedIn are the easiest for beginners, and clients search there.

Today

1. Pick one platform.
2. Follow 50 video editors and 20 creators in your niche.

☐ **Done when:** Most of what you see on that platform is editing.

DAY 7

45 MIN

Set up your profile

BOOK: CHAPTER 8

Clients check your page before they reply. Show your face and say what you do.

Today

1. Tick off the profile basics below.
2. Post once: tell people what you edit and who you help.

- [ ] A clear photo of your face
- [ ] Your name and what you edit
- [ ] Your offer sentence in your bio
- [ ] A simple banner (Canva is fine)

- [ ] **Done when:** Your profile is set and your first post is up.

WEEK 1 CHECK-IN

Days 1–7, done

Did you post every day?

1	2	3	4	5	6	7
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

What slipped this week, and what will you do about it?

Missed something? Don’t skip it. Do it first next week.

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PHASE 2 · DAYS 8–21

Learn on real videos

Learn one skill at a time on one video, and finish three full videos in your niche.

“Don't learn without implementation.”

DAY 8

30 MIN

Make your learning list

BOOK: CHAPTER 6

Only learn what your clients will pay for. Everything else can wait.

Today

1. Ask any AI: “What skills do I need to edit *[your kind of video]* for *[your clients]* on *[platform]*?”
2. Keep the 5 to 7 skills that matter most. Start with cutting, pacing, audio and captions.

My learning list, in order

☐ **Done when:** You have your list.

DAY 9

2–3 HOURS

Learn your software (part 1)

BOOK: CHAPTER 6

Learn the software first, properly. It's the tool, not the skill, but you can't skip it.

Today

1. Find one full beginner course for your software on YouTube.
2. Watch the first half with the software open, copying every step.

☐ **Done when:** You're halfway through the course.

DAY 10

2–3 HOURS

Learn your software (part 2)

BOOK: CHAPTER 6

Finish what you started.

Today

1. Watch the second half, copying every step.

☐ **Done when:** You've finished the course.

DAY 11

2 HOURS

Cut your first practice video

BOOK: CHAPTER 6

Learn one skill, then use it straight away on one video. You'll add every next skill to the same video.

Today

1. Get footage: download a raw (unedited) video in your niche from YouTube, or film yourself talking for 2 minutes.
2. Watch one tutorial on cutting. Then cut the whole video: remove everything that isn't needed.

☐ **Done when:** The whole video is cut.

DAY 12

2 HOURS

Pacing and audio

BOOK: CHAPTER 6

Same video, next skills. Good sound keeps people watching.

Today

1. Watch one tutorial on pacing and one on audio for your kind of video.
2. Apply both to the same video.

☐ **Done when:** The video flows, and the sound is clean.

DAY 13

2 HOURS

Captions

BOOK: CHAPTER 6

Many people watch with the sound off, so captions matter a lot on social media.

Today

1. Watch one tutorial on captions for your platform.
2. Add them to the same video.

☐ **Done when:** The video has clean captions.

DAY 14

2–3 HOURS

Finish video 1

BOOK: CHAPTER 6

Every effect, caption or extra clip must help the viewer understand or feel something. If it doesn't, cut it.

Today

1. Add the last skills on your list, such as extra footage over the speaker (B-roll) or sound effects.
2. Watch it once as a viewer. Cut anything that doesn't help.
3. Post it and pin it to your profile.

☐ **Done when:** Video 1 is posted and pinned.

WEEK 2 CHECK-IN

Days 8–14, done

Did you post every day?

8	9	10	11	12	13	14
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

What slipped this week, and what will you do about it?

Missed something? Don’t skip it. Do it first next week.

DAY 15

30 MIN

Pick an edit to copy

BOOK: CHAPTER 6

Recreating a professional edit is one of the fastest ways to learn.

Today

1. Find an edit you love in your niche.
2. Find and download the raw footage it was cut from.

☐ **Done when:** You have the edit and its raw footage.

DAY 16

2–3 HOURS

Recreate it

BOOK: CHAPTER 6

When you get stuck, search YouTube for that one thing, learn it, and carry on.

Today

1. Copy the edit as closely as you can.
2. Post yours next to the original: “I just recreated this edit. Did I get it right?”

☐ **Done when:** Your recreation is posted.

DAY 17

2 HOURS

Start video 2

BOOK: CHAPTER 6

Every video has a goal. A business video's goal is usually to win customers. Edit for that, not to look fancy.

Today

1. Get new footage in your niche.
2. Write the goal of this video below, then cut it.

This video's goal

- [ ] **Done when:** Video 2 is cut.

DAY 18

2–3 HOURS

Finish video 2

BOOK: CHAPTER 6

Most beginners never finish a full video. Finishing is the skill.

Today

1. Add pacing, audio, captions and the rest of your list.
2. Post it.

☐ **Done when:** Video 2 is posted.

DAY 19

2 HOURS

Start video 3

BOOK: CHAPTER 7

When you can finish three full videos in your niche, you're ready to charge.

Today

1. Choose footage as close as possible to what your dream client posts.
2. Cut it.

☐ **Done when:** Video 3 is cut.

DAY 20

2–3 HOURS

Finish video 3

BOOK: CHAPTER 7

Three full videos, start to finish. That's the test.

Today

1. Finish every layer and post it.

- [ ] Video 1
- [ ] Video 2
- [ ] Video 3

- [ ] **Done when:** All three are ticked.

DAY 21

45 MIN

Get feedback

BOOK: CHAPTER 11

Other editors will see what you can't see yet.

Today

1. Share your best video with other editors (or in the Community) and ask what to improve.
2. Fix the two biggest things they point out.

☐ **Done when:** You've made the two fixes.

WEEK 3 CHECK-IN

Days 15–21, done

Did you post every day?

15	16	17	18	19	20	21
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

What slipped this week, and what will you do about it?

Missed something? Don’t skip it. Do it first next week.

Called to Edit

3

PHASE 3 · DAYS 22–35

Real people, real work

Edit for people you know, build your portfolio, and get your first testimonial.

"Your practice work is your work."

DAY 22

30 MIN

Write your warm list

BOOK: CHAPTERS 7 AND 9

Start with people who already know you. They trust you, so they say yes faster.

Today

1. List 10 people: friends or family with a business, people making content, small businesses near you, editors who are busy.

My 10 people

☐ **Done when:** You have 10 names.

DAY 23

30 MIN

Offer free work, with a limit

BOOK: CHAPTER 7

Free is how you get real projects at the start. Always set a limit, and say you're building your portfolio, not that you're learning.

SAY IT LIKE THIS

“Let me edit five videos for you, for free. I'm building my portfolio.”

Today

1. Send that offer to 3 people on your list.

- [ ] **Done when:** 3 offers sent.

DAY 24

30 MIN

Ask around

BOOK: CHAPTER 9

Even a relative who works in a bank may know someone who needs an editor.

Today

1. Send the offer to 3 more people.
2. Ask everyone you know: “I'm a video editor. Do you know anyone who needs my service?”

☐ **Done when:** 6 offers out, and people know what you do.

DAY 25

30 MIN

Brief your first project

BOOK: CHAPTER 10

Ask before you edit. You'll know the goal, and the client sees you're serious.

Today

1. When someone says yes, ask: What is this video for? Who is it for? Any examples you like? When do you need it?
2. No yes yet? Follow up kindly, and send 3 more offers.

☐ **Done when:** You know the goal and the deadline, or 3 more offers are out.

DAY 26

2–3 HOURS

Edit the project

BOOK: CHAPTER 7

A real deadline teaches you faster than any tutorial.

Today

1. Edit for the goal they gave you.
2. Send them a short update so they know you're on it.

☐ **Done when:** The edit is almost ready.

DAY 27

1–2 HOURS

Deliver on time

BOOK: CHAPTER 7

Clients are tired of editors who miss deadlines. Being reliable is what they pay for.

Today

1. Deliver before the deadline.
2. Make the changes they ask for.

☐ **Done when:** They have their video.

DAY 28

20 MIN

Save the proof

BOOK: CHAPTER 11

Results win your next client.

Today

1. Screenshot the results: views, comments, anything they say about it.
2. Ask if you can post the video. If yes, post it.

☐ **Done when:** Screenshots are saved.

WEEK 4 CHECK-IN

Days 22–28, done

Did you post every day?

22	23	24	25	26	27	28
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

What slipped this week, and what will you do about it?

Missed something? Don’t skip it. Do it first next week.

DAY 29

2–3 HOURS

Keep going

BOOK: CHAPTER 7

Do the next video in your free limit, or start a free project for someone new.

Today

1. Edit the next video.
2. Post a behind-the-scenes clip of you working.

☐ **Done when:** The next video is moving.

DAY 30

45 MIN

Meet 5 editors

BOOK: CHAPTER 11

Other editors become friends who send you clients.

Today

1. Comment on posts from 5 editors at your level.
2. Message one of them and offer to swap feedback on each other's work.

☐ **Done when:** You've started 5 conversations.

DAY 31

2 HOURS

Build your portfolio site

BOOK: CHAPTER 8

A simple website with your videos beats a folder of links. It doesn't need to be fancy.

Today

1. Upload your best videos to YouTube as unlisted. Copy the links.
2. Give them to an AI: “Use these videos to create a simple portfolio I can link in my bio.” Build it on Framer, Canva Websites or Carrd.
3. Show 8 videos at most. Only have 3? Show 3.

My portfolio link

☐ **Done when:** The link is in your bio.

DAY 32

30 MIN

Polish your profile

BOOK: CHAPTER 8

Your profile should make people think “this person is a professional” in five seconds.

Today

1 Tick off the rest of the profile.

- [ ] Best edit pinned
- [ ] Portfolio link in bio
- [ ] People you've edited for listed

- [ ] **Done when:** All three are ticked.

DAY 33

20 MIN

Ask for a testimonial

BOOK: CHAPTER 11

A few words from a happy client make the next one trust you. Video testimonials are even stronger.

SAY IT LIKE THIS

“Could you write two lines about working with me? It would really help my portfolio.”

Today

1. Ask everyone you've edited for.
2. Put what they say on your portfolio.

- [ ] **Done when:** At least one testimonial is on your portfolio.

DAY 34

20 MIN

Ask for a token

BOOK: CHAPTER 7

Don't stay free too long. After 4 or 5 free videos for one person, ask for a small payment.

SAY IT LIKE THIS

“I've really enjoyed working on your videos. Could you pay a small amount for the next ones?”

Today

1. Ask the person you've done the most work for.

- [ ] **Done when:** You've asked.

DAY 35

45 MIN

Write your first case study

BOOK: CHAPTER 11

My first case study came from free work: about 1,000 views before me, about 4,000 after.

Today

1. Write a short post: before, what you did, after.
2. Post it and add it to your portfolio.

☐ **Done when:** It's posted.

WEEK 5 CHECK-IN

Days 29–35, done

Did you post every day?

29	30	31	32	33	34	35
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

What slipped this week, and what will you do about it?

Missed something? Don’t skip it. Do it first next week.

Called to Edit

4

PHASE 4 · DAYS 36–60

Go get your first client

Find the clients you want, warm them up, reach out every day and get them on a call.

“Getting clients is a lot of hard work. That's the truth.”

DAY 36

1 HOUR

Start your client list

BOOK: CHAPTER 9

This list is the most important thing an editor can build. Look for three signs: in your niche, makes money, needs a better editor.

Today

1. Make a sheet in Notion or Google Sheets with columns: name, link, email, follow-ups.
2. Add 10 creators who show all three signs. On Instagram, 1,000 to 20,000 followers is the sweet spot.

☐ **Done when:** 10 names on your list.

DAY 37

1 HOUR

Grow it to 20

BOOK: CHAPTER 9

The more names, the more chances.

Today

1. Add 10 more names.
2. Find their emails. On YouTube, many put one on their About page.

☐ **Done when:** 20 names, most with emails.

DAY 38

30 MIN

Warm them up

BOOK: CHAPTER 9

When you comment on someone's posts for a while, they notice you. By the time you message, you're not a stranger.

Today

1. Turn on notifications for your top 10.
2. Leave a real, specific comment on each one's latest post. Keep doing this every day.

☐ **Done when:** 10 comments posted.

DAY 39

45 MIN

Set your prices

BOOK: CHAPTER 10

Charge per video, never per minute. Price by what goes into the video.

Today

1. Write three price levels: simple, medium, full.
2. Write what's in each, and a price in the currency your clients pay in.

Simple / medium / full: what's in each, and the price

- [ ] **Done when:** You can answer “How much?” without panic.

DAY 40

45 MIN

Get paid safely

BOOK: CHAPTER 10

The common scam: you deliver and never get paid. Take about 30% before you start.

Today

1. Find out how clients abroad can pay you in your country. Ask people near you who already earn online.
2. Save a simple agreement: number of videos, 30% upfront, balance on delivery, rounds of changes.

- [ ] I know how I'll receive money
- [ ] My agreement is ready

- [ ] **Done when:** Both boxes are ticked.

DAY 41

45 MIN

Send your first DMs

BOOK: CHAPTER 9

Don't open with a pitch. Start a conversation about their video first.

EXAMPLE

“Hi Joshua, I loved your video on B2B sales. How do you make these?”

Today

1. Message 3 creators you've been commenting on. Voice notes work even better.
2. Write each one in your list.

☐ **Done when:** 3 DMs sent.

DAY 42

45 MIN

Send your first emails

BOOK: CHAPTER 9

Prove you watched. Name the exact video, and mention something from the middle of it.

Today

1. Email 3 people on your list: what you noticed in their video, how it could do better, and an offer of a free edit.

☐ **Done when:** 3 emails sent.

WEEK 6 CHECK-IN

Days 36–42, done

Did you post every day?

36	37	38	39	40	41	42
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

What slipped this week, and what will you do about it?

Missed something? Don’t skip it. Do it first next week.

DAY 43

1–2 HOURS

Edit their video first

BOOK: CHAPTER 9

Don't wait to be asked. Re-edit a piece of their video and show them. Never more than 30 seconds.

Today

1. Pick a video on your list you can clearly improve.
2. Re-edit 30 seconds of it. Make a before and after.

☐ **Done when:** Your before and after is ready.

DAY 44

30 MIN

Send it everywhere

BOOK: CHAPTER 9

You don't know which app they'll open, so use more than one.

Today

1. Email it to them.
2. Post it and tag them.
3. Send it by DM too.

☐ **Done when:** Sent three ways.

DAY 45

45 MIN

Pitch on video

BOOK: CHAPTER 9

A short video of you feels real. Most emails today are written by AI.

Today

1. Record a 2-minute Loom: who you are, what you noticed in their video, how you'd improve it.
2. Email it to one person on your list.

☐ **Done when:** 1 Loom sent.

DAY 46

30 MIN

Follow up

BOOK: CHAPTER 9

Most replies come after the first message. Space it out: 1 day, 2 days, 1 week. Stop after four.

SAY IT LIKE THIS

“Hey, just checking whether you saw my last message. I'd really love to know what you think.”

Today

1. Send every follow-up that's due.
2. Add 10 more names to your list.

☐ **Done when:** Follow-ups sent, 30 names on your list.

DAY 47

45 MIN

Get ready for “How much?”

BOOK: CHAPTERS 9 AND 10

Don't give your price in a DM. Ask about their goals, then move them to a video call.

Today

1. Set up a free booking link (Calendly or Cal.com).
2. Write your reply below and keep it ready to paste.

My reply when someone asks my price

☐ **Done when:** Your booking link and reply are ready.

DAY 48

30 MIN

Practise a call

BOOK: CHAPTER 9

People say no easily in a chat. On a video call, they think twice. Practise before it counts.

Today

1. Do a pretend sales call with a friend: ask about their goals, explain your price, ask for the work.

☐ **Done when:** You've done one practice call.

DAY 49

2 HOURS

Your daily rhythm

BOOK: CHAPTER 9

From today, getting clients is a daily habit. Same five things, every day.

Today

1. Do the five things below. Tick them as you go.

- [ ] Add 5 names to your client list
- [ ] Send 3 new messages (DM, email or Loom)
- [ ] Send the follow-ups that are due
- [ ] Comment on 5 of your creators' posts
- [ ] Post 2 to 3 times

- [ ] **Done when:** All five are ticked.

WEEK 7 CHECK-IN

Days 43–49, done

Did you post every day?

43	44	45	46	47	48	49
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

What slipped this week, and what will you do about it?

Missed something? Don’t skip it. Do it first next week.

DAYS 50–55

2 HOURS A DAY

Keep the rhythm

BOOK: CHAPTERS 9 AND 11

Do your five every day. Some days have one extra task.

Your five, every day

- Add 5 names to your client list
- Send 3 new messages (DM, email or Loom)
- Send the follow-ups that are due
- Comment on 5 of your creators' posts
- Post 2 to 3 times

Tick each day when your five are done

Day 50	Extra: find 3 agencies posting that they need an editor (Twitter, LinkedIn) and message them	☐
Day 51	Extra: make a second 30-second before and after, and send it	☐
Day 52	Extra: tell 2 busy editors you know you'd love to help them	☐
Day 53	Your five	☐
Day 54	Extra: send a second Loom	☐
Day 55	Your five	☐

DAY 56

30 MIN

Check your numbers

BOOK: CHAPTER 9

Your numbers show you what's working.

Today

1. Count the messages you've sent, the replies, and the calls.
2. Find what got the most replies: DMs, emails, Looms or before and afters.

Sent / replies / calls / clients

What got the most replies

☐ **Done when:** You know what to do more of.

WEEK 8 CHECK-IN

Days 50–56, done

Did you post every day?

50	51	52	53	54	55	56
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

What slipped this week, and what will you do about it?

Missed something? Don’t skip it. Do it first next week.

DAYS 57–59

2 HOURS A DAY

Do more of what works

BOOK: CHAPTER 9

Keep your five every day, with more of what got replies.

Your five, every day

- Add 5 names to your client list
- Send 3 new messages (DM, email or Loom)
- Send the follow-ups that are due
- Comment on 5 of your creators' posts
- Post 2 to 3 times

Tick each day when your five are done

Day 57	Extra: double what got the most replies	☐
Day 58	Extra: third follow-ups: “I know you're busy, but I still feel I can really help.”	☐
Day 59	Extra: add any new work and testimonials to your portfolio	☐

DAY 60

45 MIN

Look back, plan the next 60

BOOK: CHAPTER 12

Sixty days doesn't guarantee a client. Nothing does. But keep doing all of it for one, two, three months, and you give yourself the best chance there is.

Today

1. Read your Day 1 answers and see how far you've come.
2. Got a client? Take 30% upfront, sign the agreement, deliver on time, save the results.
3. Plan your next 60 days: keep what worked, drop what didn't.

My plan for the next 60 days

☐ **Done when:** You know your next step.

Called to Edit
COMMUNITY

YOU DON'T HAVE TO DO THIS ALONE

Do the 60 days with editors who are doing them too

Post each day's work in the Called to Edit Community. I'll give you feedback on your edits, your outreach and your profile, and correct you as you go.

- Feedback from me on your work, your outreach and your profile
- Calls with me inside the community
- Editors at your level, on the same 60 days

NGN 5,000 a month

About USD 4. Open to any editor, anywhere. Find me on Instagram: @SamuelSignals

Called to
Edit

I coach video editors to get paid.

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